India has more than 2000 ethnic groups, and every major religion is represented, as are four major families of languages (IndoEuropean, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Sino-Tibetan languages) as well as two language isolates (the Nihali language spoken in parts of Maharashtra and the Burushaski language spoken in parts of Jammu and Kashmir (Kashmir).

Further complexity is lent by the great variation that occurs across this population on social parameters such as income and education. Only the continent of Africa exceeds the linguistic, genetic and cultural diversity of the nation of India.

9. India is the second most populated country of the world after China. Population of India is projected close to 1.37 billion or 1369 million in 2019, compare to 1.354 billion in 2018. Population growth rate for 2019 is projected at 1.08%. India will add 1.49 cr in 2019 that is near to current population of 74th ranked Somalia.

   India accounts for a meagre 2.4% of the world surface area of 135.79 million square kms yet it supports and sustains a whopping 17.75% of the world population. It is now estimated that by 2024, India will most likely overtake China to become the most populous country on the earth with 1.44 billion people. And by 2029, India will cross the 1.5 billion mark. Population of India will decrease after 2061.

10. According to the Census of India 2011, the population of India stood at 1,210,854,977 comprising of 623,270,258 males and 587,584,719 females. The percentage decadal growth during 2001-2011 was 17.70%, 3.84% lower than 1991-2001 period.

    The percentage decadal growth during 20012011 has registered the sharpest decline since Independence. Population of India has increased by 182.1 million during the decade 2001-2011. The increased population during the decade 2001-2011 is approximately equal to the population of Pakistan, the sixth most populous country in the world.

11. This uneven distribution of the population is due to the varying population density of the country. Population density = the total number of people per unit of area. Also, population density is largely dependent on the geographical location and geological factors.